

News & Analysis

driven by the PitchBook Platform

[ARTICLES](#)[RESEARCH
CENTER](#)[All](#)

VENTURE CAPITAL

Big money's back: European VC mega-rounds pick up

By Leah Hodgson

Published July 17, 2025

Despite an overall slowdown for Europe's VC markets, mega-rounds are making a comeback.

Dealmaking in the region is currently pacing below last year's numbers for both round count and value, but there has been an uptick in the number of deals worth over €100 million.

According to PitchBook’s [Q2 2025 European Venture Report](#), 53 such deals closed this year, worth an aggregate €10.7 billion (about \$12.4 billion).

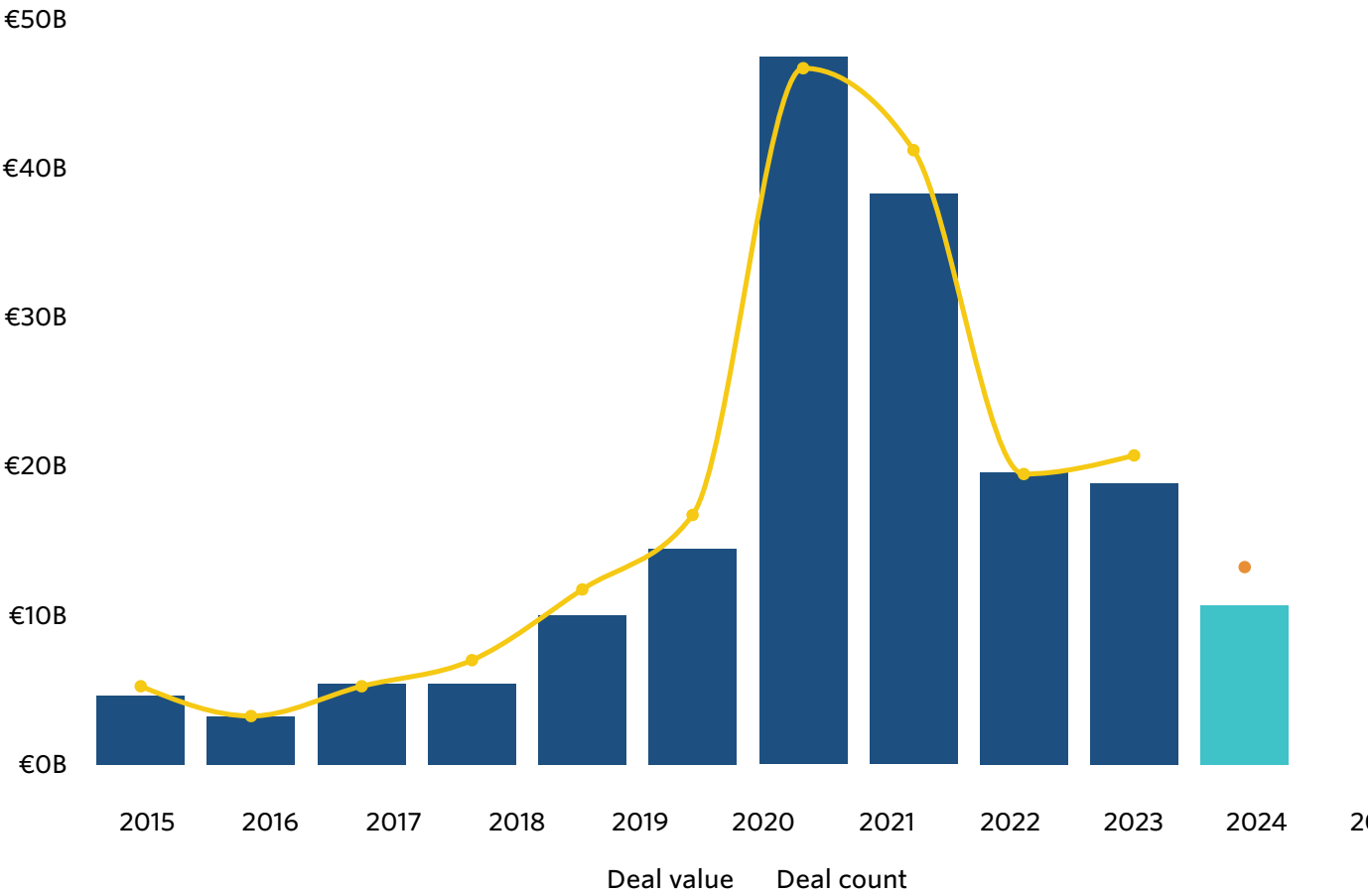
Join the more than 2 million industry professionals who get our daily newsletter!

Business email:*

I agree to PitchBook’s [privacy policy](#)

Subscribe

European mega-rounds pace higher



Source: [Q2 2025 European Venture Report](#) • As of June 30, 2025

The current run rate implies a 13.4% increase in deal value and a 27.7% rise in count compared to 2024. The year is on track for its highest level of mega-rounds since 2022.

AI accounted for the largest share of mega-rounds and now claims more than a third of all European VC deals. Companies, including AI video content generator [Synthesia](#) and enterprise AI systems builder [AI21 Labs](#), were among those to have raised 9-figure amounts.

Defense tech was a busy space for mega-deals, claiming around 10% of total mega-round value, as investment in the vertical reaches [new heights this year](#).

A €600 million Series D raised by Germany's [Helsing](#) topped the list of the largest VC rounds this year. Drone makers [Quantum Systems](#) and [Tekever](#) also completed mega-rounds, becoming unicorns in May.

Life sciences also drew a significant number of mega-rounds, particularly for companies that intersect with AI. Drug discovery startup [Isomorphic Labs](#) pulled in \$600 million in its first external funding round in March.

Among investors in Europe's mega-rounds, many of the same names appear in multiple deals. Notably, many of the VCs that have been the most active in mega-deals this year are US-based.

[General Catalyst](#) has been one of the most prolific this year, backing companies including Helsing and body scanning startup [Neko Health](#), which raised a \$260 million Series B.

Local investors such as [Balderton Capital](#) and [HV Capital](#) have also participated in several large rounds, including fusion energy startup [Proxima Fusion](#)'s €130 million Series A and robotics marker [Neura Robotics](#).

Featured image by DNY59/Getty Images

Learn more about our [editorial standards](#).



About [Leah Hodgson](#)

Leah Hodgson is a London-based senior reporter for PitchBook, covering the venture capital ecosystem across Europe and the Middle East. Leah, who joined PitchBook in 2018, graduated from the University of Surrey with a BA in international politics with French. She has previously been a radio reporter in France. She later turned to financial journalism, covering the wealth management industry.

Share:

Tags:

[Venture Capital](#)

[Europe](#)

Related content



PE EXITS

5 charts: Traditional PE exits may be reopening—but mainly in North America

August 19, 2025

Europe lagged behind North America in all three routes



FEATURED

'SPAC King' Chamath Palihapitiya is back with a new one

August 18, 2025

The American Exceptionalism Acquisition Corp. will focus on energy, AI, decentralized finance...



IPO

Blockchain-based lender Figure files for IPO

August 18, 2025

The company has been profitable since 2024.

[Load More](#)

Products

Solutions

Data

News & Analysis

Follow us



